



William “Bill” Reginald Abbati

1895 – 1916

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	William Reginald Abbati Known as Bill according to students and on the 1901 census as Willie	CWGC and 1911 census and the following website https://www.friendsofeastcowes.co.uk/burials/grave-search/search-result.php Students research 1901 census
Date of Birth	26/9/1895	GRO index for Dec Qtr 1895, and his baptism certificate, see below Also UCL Matriculation application (doc saved on my laptop)
Date of Death	7/8/1916 as recorded on the Commonwealth war graves commission However, 9/8/1916 as recorded on his gravestone His death is registered on the Isle of Wight	CWGC GRO index

	He is buried/commemorated in Cowes (Kingston) Cemetery, R.C.40. There is a poor image of the tombstone but it states he died on 9/8/1916 Better image and info here. He died in Osborne House Hospital, Parish of Whippingham, IoW UofL also say 9/8/1916	CWGC https://www.friendsofeastcowes.co.uk/burials/grave-search/search-result.php
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	20	https://www.friendsofeastcowes.co.uk/burials/grave-search/search-result.php
Marital Status	Single	
Children (if any)	none	
Occupation prior to Call up	He was at college preparing to study Engineering but left due to poor eye sight	
Parents	Camille Abbati (bn Syra, Greece also known as Syros) and his wife Mathilde (bn in Genoa, Italy)	1911 census
Listed Address(s)	[Ardmore], 79 Harrow View, Wealdstone University College say his parents lived in Chiswick. UCL documents relating to his admission give Ingle Nook, Dukes Avenue, Chiswick as an address so this is where that's come from. They must have moved after 1911	1911 census Ancestry
Parents /Fathers occupation	Steamship Broker in Grain and was an employer	1911 census
Brothers and Sisters	Margaret (older) Henry (older), Alfred (older)	1911 census 1901 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)	University College London briefly,	

	see below. He matriculated in Jan 1913 and was going to study engineering	Ancestry
Obituary	I've yet to find an obituary except for UCL below	
War Memorials	John Lyon School memorials (spelt wrong I believe) UofL. This page says he died of wounds but their own biography below states quite the opposite. If he had died of wounds I would have expected to see a CWGC memorial in the churchyard. UofL OTC Roll of the Fallen	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/340954 https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/11318 https://archives.libraries.london.ac.uk/resources/WARLISToptimised-OCR.pdf On Ancestry see below
	I've not found him on any other war memorials searching the IWM database by both spellings	

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	ABBATI W.R.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/2758732/abbati,-/
Age	21
DoD	07-Aug-16
Rank	2 Lt
Regiment	Essex Regiment 3rd Bn
Location	Cowes (Kingston) Cemetery
Military details	Did not serve overseas

Photo



William Reginald Abbati **Original Photo**



William Reginald Abbati **AI Enhanced Photo**

Story of Sacrifice

William Reginald Abbati (1895 – 1916)

William “Bill” Abbati was born on 26 September 1895 in Highbury, London, the son of Camille Abbati, a steamship broker, and Mathilde Abbati. He grew up with his older siblings, Margaret, Henry, and Alfred. The family lived at 79 Harrow View, Wealdstone in 1911 before later moving to Chiswick.

Civilian Life

Bill Abbati was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon School, Harrow, before entering University College London in 1912. He passed both the College Engineering Matriculation and the University Matriculation examinations in January 1913 with the intention of studying engineering. However, he was forced to discontinue his studies later that year because of poor eyesight. He remained unmarried and had no children.

Military Life

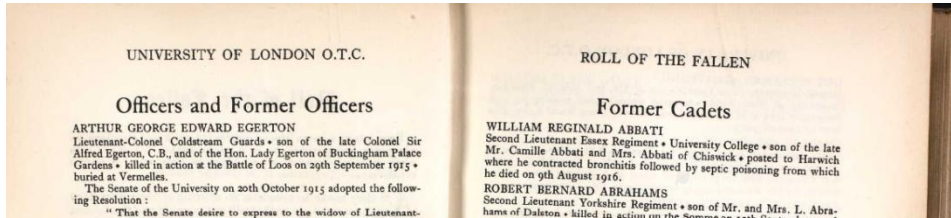
Although his eyesight had interrupted his education, Abbati was a member of the University Officers' Training Corps and applied for a commission only days after the outbreak of the First World War. In September 1914 he enlisted in the London Scottish as a private and, approximately three months later, was gazetted as a Second Lieutenant in the 3rd Battalion, Essex Regiment. He was posted to Harwich and did not serve overseas.

During his service he contracted bronchitis. After a partial recovery he returned to duty, but later suffered a relapse which developed into septic poisoning of the lung. His health continued to deteriorate, and he relinquished his commission on medical grounds in April 1916. He died at the Osborne Convalescent Home for Officers on the Isle of Wight on 9 August 1916, according to the University College London and cemetery records, although some sources record 7 August 1916. He was buried at Cowes (Kingston) Cemetery. The University College records state that he never reached the Front and that his death resulted from illness rather than wounds received in action.

Notes & Clippings

The following is from University College where he was a student for a brief period. It confirms that he didn't die of war wounds and in fact never went to the front. He is still on all the rolls of honour, however but it can't be said he died in battle.	
WILLIAM REGINALD ABBATI, son of Camille Abbati and Mrs. Abbati, of Chiswick, was born on September 26th, 1895. He was educated at the Lower School John Lyon, Harrow, and entered U.C.L. in 1912. In January, 1913, he passed the College Engineering Matric. and the University Matric., but had to stop work in the Autumn owing to bad eyesight. He had been in the O.T.C. throughout his short College career and he applied for a commission (August 17th, 1914) within a few days of the outbreak of war. "It was his great ambition to get to the Front." In spite of his bad eyesight, he enlisted in the London Scottish in September, 1914, as a private, until he was gazetted 2nd Lieut., 3rd Essex Regiment, three months later. He was then posted at Harwich. In these early days of the War, owing to shortage of materials, service was unavoidably under very trying conditions. Abbati contracted bronchitis, partially recovered, but insisted on cutting down his leave for convalescence; after a few months he had a relapse which brought about septic poisoning in the lung; nevertheless he still continued on service until forced to his bed. His case was then hopeless; he had to relinquish his commission on account of ill-health in April, 1916, and died on August 9th at the Osborne Convalescent Home for Officers. He was buried at East Cowes, Isle of Wight. <i>(College Records; Photograph by Wakefields, Ltd., Chiswick.)</i>	Clip Transcript: College Records: WILLIAM REGINALD ABBATI, son of Camille Abbati and Mrs. Abbati, of Chiswick, was born on September 26th, 1895. He was educated at the Lower School John Lyon, Harrow, and entered U.C.L. in 1912. In January, 1913, he passed the College Engineering Matric. and the University Matric., but had to stop work in the Autumn owing to bad eyesight. He had been in the O.T.C. throughout his short College career and he applied for a commission (August 17th, 1914) within a few days of the outbreak of war. "It was his great ambition to get to the Front." In spite of his bad eyesight, he enlisted in the London Scottish in September, 1914, as a private, until he was gazetted 2nd Lieut., 3rd Essex Regiment, three months later. He was then posted at Harwich. In these early days of the War, owing to short-age of materials, service was unavoidably under very trying conditions. Abbati contracted bronchitis, partially recovered, but insisted on cutting down his leave for convalescence; after a few months he had a relapse which brought about septic poisoning in the lung; nevertheless he still continued on service until forced to his bed. His case was then hopeless; he had to re-linquish his commission on account of ill-health in April, 1916, and died on August 9th at the Osborne Convalescent Home for Officers. He was buried at East Cowes, Isle of Wight. (College Records; Photograph by Wakefields, Ltd., Chiswick.) (sic . no Photograph available)

University of London OTC Roll of the Fallen – NB date of death contradicts the CWGC but agrees with Cowes Cemetery
Also note it says son of the LATE Mr Camille Abbati – he didn’t die until 1918 so it depends when this roll was made up (His mother in 1933)



Clip Transcript:
University of London O. T. C.
ROLL OF THE FALLEN
Former Cadets
WILLIAM REGINALD ABBATI
Second Lieutenant Essex Regiment • University College • son of the late Mr. Camille Abbati and Mrs. Abbati of Chiswick • posted to Harwich where he contracted bronchitis followed by septic poisoning from which he died on 9th August 1916.

Abbati, W R



William 'Bill' Abbati served as a second lieutenant of the Essex Regiment. He was born in Croydon in 1896 and died at the age of 21 on 9th August 1916. He was posthumously awarded the Victory and British War Medals. He did not appear to have fought in a battle; however, he died in Felixstowe while serving with the 3rd Battalion.

Lieutenant William Abbati (3rd Essex Regiment) died after a severe illness following constant exposure during training. He was at Osborne House, but he was not able to recover.

The evidence of the baptism certificate confirm he was born in 1895 (see above). Also his birth was registered in Islington NOT Croydon (source: GRO)

Also the 1901 census states he was born in Highbury.

Clip Transcript: Abbati, W R

William 'Bill' Abbati served as a second lieutenant of the Essex Regiment. He was born in Croydon (sic. He was born in Highbury) in 1896 (sic. 1895) and died at the age of 21 on 9th August 1916. He was posthumously awarded the Victory and British War Medals. He did not appear to have fought in a battle; however, he died in Felixstowe (sic. He died on the Isle of Wight) while serving with the 3rd Battalion.

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Civilian Notes

Only one family named Abbati found in the 1911 census for E&W. They lived in Harrow on the Hill.

Spelling of Surname:

ABBATI: on the CWGC; 1911 census (filled out by his father) and the 1901 census which his father would have provided the information; GRO indexes to births and deaths it's; in the cemetery on IoW; University College; baptism certificate

ABATTI: on the John Lyon School memorial and sundial; IWM index to war memorials – they've taken the spelling from the John Lyon School memorials

NB: on the website Lives of the First World War it states his death was not war related.

NB: Not on Evermore or any other war memorial indexed by Imperial War Museum (IWM). He is not on Cowes war memorial presumably as he didn't die on active duty

When did he die? 7 or 9 of August 1916 – some disagreements – his gravestone says 9/8/1916

Friends of East Cowes Cemetery hold the following info which provided the middle name and a much better photograph of the monument and clarifies that he died in hospital in Osborne

<https://www.friendsofeastcowes.co.uk/burials/grave-search/search-result.php>



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Database results for 'Abbati' at Kingston

To refine search results, use [the advance search feature](#).

1 Records found

Surname	Forenames	Description	Birth (approx)	Death (Burial)	Cemetery	
Abbati	William Reginald	(RC). Lieutenant, HM Army	1896	1916	Kingston	View record 

Baptism Certificate confirming date of birth – 26/9/1895 at Islington St John the Evangelist (Roman Catholic)

Privatum
in periculo mortis

Abbat

10 Abensdeen Park
Lapraugh, Cañon, N. M.
22 Octobris 1896

Die 26 Septembris 1895 natus et die 22 Decembris 1895 baptizatus est

Guilhelmus Reginaldus Abbat filius Camilli & Mathildae

Abbat (olim Pierana) conjugum:

a me Leopoldo ycke M. R.

Patrinus fuit Reginaldus March Turnbull Matrina fuit



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William Reginald Abbati

Forename(s): **William Reginald**

Surname: **Abbati**

(RC). Lieutenant, HM Army

Date of birth: **1896 (approx., calculated)**

Date of death: **9 Aug 1916**

Date of burial: **11 Aug 1916**

Age at death: **20 years**

Died at: **Osborne House Hospital, Parish of Whippingham**

Section: **D** - [Cemetery map](#)

Plot No: **40** [Section map of plots](#)

[See others in this section](#)

Burial Register entry: **Kingston 1544**

External link(s):

isle-of-wight-memorials.org.uk

Kingston Cemetery

